

Chest holding
Thaisa, found
on the seashore

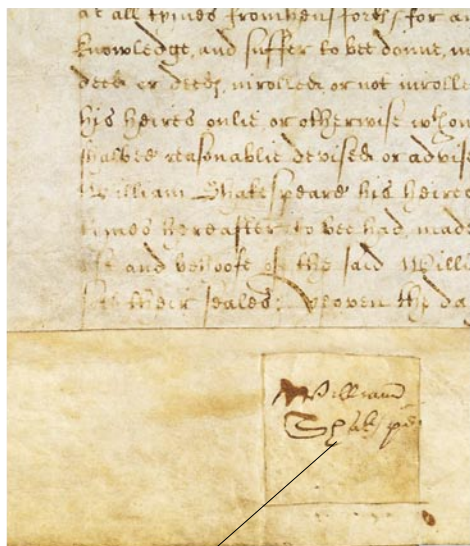
MIRACULOUS MUSIC

Pericles is set in the Mediterranean, with shipwrecks and pirates featuring in the action. Pericles, Prince of Tyre, buries his wife Thaisa at sea after she dies giving birth to their daughter. Thaisa is washed ashore at Ephesus, where she is brought back to life by the miraculous healing power of music.

FANCY FASHION

A fashion for a type of court entertainment called a masque – a mixture of ballet, opera, and ornate costumes – influenced staging at the Blackfriars. At court, performers recited poems, sang, and danced in front of elaborate sets. The King and his courtiers often joined in. In *The Tempest*, Prospero stages his own masque with the help of magic.

Illustration from
*The Children's
Shakespeare* by
Charles
Folkard,
1911



The playwright's
signature

Part of the legal
document giving
Shakespeare the rights to
the house at Blackfriars

PERSONAL PROPERTY

In 1613, Shakespeare bought a house just around the corner from the Blackfriars playhouse. He may have intended to live there, or may simply have bought it as an investment. Shakespeare did not spend much time in his new house. He had already gone back to live in Stratford and would soon give up writing plays.

Woman
in a masque
costume, c. 1615